

*Ashburnham-Westminster Regional School District
Superintendent's FY 2027
Preliminary Operating Budget*



**School Committee Meeting
February 5, 2026**





"In the Ashburnham Westminster Regional School District every student is known, challenged and supported every day so that all graduates are prepared to do good and to do well while being well."

Ashburnham-Westminster District Goals 2026-2027

- **Continue** structures and supports necessary for all student's success
- **Maintain** Class Size
- **Provide** a safe, clean, energy-efficient, and adequate learning environment
- **Ensure** that co-curricular, arts, music and athletic budgets are preserved
- **Promote** financial and programmatic stability in subsequent fiscal years

FY 2027

Proposed Budget

FY 2026 Certified: \$39,116,620

FY 2027 Proposed: \$40,233,975

Operating Increase: \$1,117,355

Operating Increase %: **2.9%**

FY2027 Budget Drivers

- Contractual Increases
- Increase in Worcester County Retirement Costs
- Increased Insurance Costs

FY 2027 Operating Budget Summary

	FY26 Budget	FY27 Budget	\$ Change	% Change
Contractual Salary Increases	\$ 24,072,786	\$ 24,884,600	\$ 811,814	3.4%
Benefits and Insurance	\$ 5,040,364	\$ 5,700,239	\$ 659,875	13.1%
Transportation	\$ 2,317,260	\$ 2,436,655	\$ 119,395	5.2%
Worcester County Retirement	\$ 1,117,052	\$ 1,224,587	\$ 107,535	9.6%
Facilities Supplies, Services, and Utilities	\$ 2,257,450	\$ 2,287,162	\$ 29,712	1.3%
Reinstate Girls Ice Hockey- Offset by user fees		\$ 28,000	\$ 28,000	
Athletics	\$ 673,084	\$ 691,293	\$ 18,209	2.7%
Special Ed Supplies and Services	\$ 504,660	\$ 517,800	\$ 13,140	2.6%
Districtwide Supplies and Services	\$ 161,725	\$ 165,741	\$ 4,016	2.5%
Marching Band	\$ 82,650	\$ 86,650	\$ 4,000	4.8%
Oakmont Supplies and Services	\$ 92,229	\$ 94,229	\$ 2,000	2.2%
Westminster/ Meetinghouse Supplies and Services	\$ 57,252	\$ 57,252	\$ -	0.0%
Overlook Supplies and Services	\$ 51,335	\$ 51,335	\$ -	0.0%
Nurses Supplies and Services	\$ 25,784	\$ 25,784	\$ -	0.0%
JR Briggs Supplies and Services	\$ 48,750	\$ 48,750	\$ -	0.0%
Professional Development	\$ 182,720	\$ 182,720	\$ -	0.0%
Technology Supplies and Services	\$ 1,183,785	\$ 1,115,678	\$ (68,107)	-5.8%
Out of District Tuitions	\$ 865,000	\$ 765,000	\$ (100,000)	-11.6%
Reduce 2 Elementary FTE		\$ (130,000)	\$ (130,000)	
Debt	\$ 382,734	\$ -	\$ (382,734)	-100.0%
Grand Total	\$ 39,116,620	\$ 40,233,475	\$ 1,116,855	2.9%

REVENUE PROJECTIONS

Chapter 70 Revenue

FY2026 Governor's Budget

\$16,095,762

FY2027 Governor's Budget

\$16,426,437

An Increase of \$330,675 or 2.05%

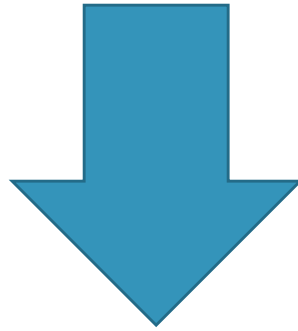
State Revenue

State Funding	FY26 Budget	FY27 Projections	\$Change
Chapter 70	\$ 16,095,762	\$ 16,426,437	\$ 330,675
Regional Transportation	\$ 1,110,000	\$ 1,213,745	\$ 113,745
Charter Reimbursement	\$ 45,000	\$ 61,299	\$ 16,299
Total State Funding	\$ 17,240,762	\$ 17,701,481	\$ 460,719

Local Funding

Local Funding	FY26 Budget	FY27 Projections	\$Change
Interest Income	\$ 70,000	\$ 125,000	\$ 55,000
Athletic Admissions	\$ 15,000	\$ 15,000	\$ -
Student Fees	\$ 200,000	\$ 215,000	\$ 15,000
Building Rental & Fees	\$ 100,000	\$ 100,000	\$ -
Medicaid Reimbursement	\$ 200,000	\$ 200,000	\$ -
Miscellaneous Revenue	\$ 30,000	\$ 30,000	\$ -
E&D	\$ 400,000	\$ 600,000	\$ 200,000
Total Local Funding	\$ 1,015,000	\$ 1,285,000	\$ 270,000

How do we calculate Annual Operating Assessments?



Required
Minimum
Local
Contribution + Town's Share
Over
Minimum* + Transportation
Costs

* Calculated using % foundation enrollment from each individual town.

Foundation Enrollment

	Oct 1 2024	%	Oct 1 2025	Change	%	% Change
Ashburnham	990	44.49%	982	-8	44.96%	0.47%
Westminster	1235	55.51%	1202	-33	55.04%	-0.47%
Total Enrollment	2,225		2,184	-41		

Transportation

➤ Regular	\$1,991,655
➤ Special Ed	\$362,000
➤ Homeless	\$30,000
➤ Foster	\$53,000

Transportation

Gross Total:

\$ 2,436,655 - \$ 1,213,745 (Ch. 71)*

- Total Cost of Transportation for Member Towns:
\$1,222,910

Ashburnham \$549,820

Westminster \$673,090

* Uncertain reimbursement rate.

Required Minimum Contribution

The state calculates each city and town's ability to contribute local revenue towards the operation of its schools. Local ability to contribute varies widely based upon the incomes and property values of different cities and towns. The state expects that each municipality can contribute the same share of local resources to the foundation budget by setting uniform contribution rates.

The minimum local takes the town's equalized valuation and town's reported income to come up with a combined effort number which is the towns target contribution. It then uses the towns municipal growth factor and last years required contribution to calculate a preliminary contribution. The preliminary contribution is then adjusted based on the target contribution.

	FY26	FY27	\$ Change	% Change
Ashburnham	\$ 6,245,654	\$ 6,566,149	\$ 320,495	5.13%
Westminster	\$ 9,417,854	\$ 9,811,890	\$ 394,036	4.18%

Assessments

		FY26 Budget	FY27 Budget	\$Change	% Change
Ashburnham	Net Minimum Requirement	\$ 6,245,654	\$ 6,566,149	\$ 320,495	5.13%
	Above Minimum Contribution	\$ 1,601,066	\$ 1,636,012	\$ 34,945	2.18%
	Transportation	\$ 537,555	\$ 549,820	\$ 12,265	2.28%
	Community Service	\$ 3,559	\$ 3,597	\$ 38	1.06%
	Debt Service	\$ 174,453		\$ (174,453)	-100%
	Total Ashburnham	\$ 8,562,287	\$ 8,755,2579	\$ 193,292	2.26%
Westminster	Net Minimum Requirement	\$ 9,417,854	\$ 9,811,890	\$ 394,036	4.18%
	Above Minimum Contribution	\$ 1,997,290	\$ 2,002,533	\$ 5,243	0.26%
	Transportation	\$ 670,705	\$ 673,090	\$ 2,385	0.36%
	Community Service	\$ 4,441	\$ 4,403	\$ (38)	-0.85%
	Debt Service	\$ 208,282		\$ (208,282)	-100.00%
	Total Westminster	\$ 12,298,571	\$ 12,491,915	\$ 193,344	1.57%
	Total Local Assessment	\$ 20,860,858	\$ 21,247,494	\$ 386,636	1.85%

Questions,
Comments,
Feedback...